

ascertaining exactly how much time you have to report manufacturing defects and get the products replaced. For most consumer electronics products purchased from brick and mortar shops, this period is usually seven days. Displays purchased from reputed online stores such as Flipkart or Amazon can come with generous 15 to 30 day returns guarantees. After we have figured out how much time you have, we move onto the more challenging aspect. That is, putting the display through the paces to reveal any inherent manufacturing flaws.

Ensuring whether the TV or monitor has shipped with all packaged contents is a good place to begin. Replacing a standard cable is easy, but it's not good if your display has shipped without an important proprietary accessory or a remote. The next step involves checking the display for any physical defects or damage. Check the body for dents (in case of metal chassis) or tell-tale white marks where the plastic body may have warped. Do this especially near the screw bosses for VESA mounting point and other snap-on attachment points. What you're essentially checking for is to ascertain whether you haven't received a used, refurbished, or open unit. While the chance of that happening is slim, wise men don't rely on the honesty of their vendors.

Thereafter, check the area between the inner side of the screen bezel and the panel for any tell-tale nicks or marks, which could be a sign of the product being opened for panel replacement for refurbishing. Checking this gap for uniformity is also a good indicator of the unit's build quality, because the gap between the bezel and the panel largely dictates how controlled or severe the backlight bleeding issue will be for LCD/LED panels. Now that we know that the display isn't physically broken, switch it on and test all the I/O ports. It's better to find out about a faulty Display Port input now rather than a year later when in the unlikely event that you will have upgraded to a Display Port-only graphics card. Run through all the setup menus and check every mode and software setting to verify whether everything works as advertised.

Don't Forget to Check the Panel

Well, congratulations. You seem to have a perfectly working display. Albeit, with the minor exception of the display panel. Which is, you know, pretty much the most important aspect of the TV/monitor itself. Begin by opening MS Paint and pressing <Ctrl> + <e> to bring up the "Image Properties/Attributes" menu and setting the image width/height to the native resolution of